

EL TORBELLINO

NEWSLETTER OF SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS FREE FLIGHT CLUB



May 2026

The Prez's Corner – Don Bartick

Arline and I went to 2 contests during the month of April. One at Perris for the Orbiteers monthly. The other at Lost Hills for the San Valeers Annual.

The turn out at Perris was good; the weather was good, and lots of flying going on. P-30 was the main attraction and well competed. As I had indicated in previous articles published in the ET, P-30 continues to be the most competed AMA Free Flight event in the world. More regarding P-30 further down in this musing. As far as Perris, I was very surprised that the field hasn't been attended to per the fee structure that the participating clubs paid. The area where we park and setup is extremely rough. The field where we fly from wasn't that bad, but once you get off of this field, the chase is over plowed land with furrows sprouting some sort of grass that was 12 to 18 inches high. A couple chases for us old guys put a damper on flying more then one event. Aside from that, you had to have a very good line on your plane or otherwise it will hide on you in the grasses. So having Perris available for us to fly is a good thing, but actually flying there is becoming tougher and tougher for me and others that have passed our youth. The young folks on the field just run after their planes thinking nothing about the chase. I remember those days, so long ago. At least I remember.

The San Valeers Annual was over 4 days. You could fly any event, any day unless it was specifically scheduled: such as, Vintage Wakefield, Vintage FAI Power and all the other FAI events. The attendance was down from last year. The combined AMA, NOS, OT and FAI registration was under 50. Last year, it was in the 70's. The weather was cool, with winds out of the East ranging from calm to 8mph. Saturday was a blowout. At least we had 3 of the 4 flyable days. Not bad for the time of the year. As far as my results, I got 1st in P-30 and didn't place in E-36.

With regard to P-30, my article about the creation of the P-30 Exhibit for the National Model Aircraft Museum in Muncie, IN was finally published in the January/February 2026 National Free Flight Society Digest. Take a look when you have a chance.

That's a wrap.

Remember: Simplicity is the Ultimate Sophistication.

Author: Leonardo da Vinci



Photo's by Arline Bartick

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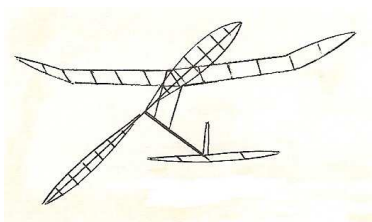
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ORBITEERS MEMBERSHIP DUES

Annual Membership - \$20
Lifetime Membership - \$250
Non-Member Newsletter Subscription - \$15
Junior Members 16 years old or younger - Free

Submit Dues to Club Treasurer:

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THE FINE PRINT THE FINE PRINT

El Torbellino is the official newsletter of the San Diego Orbiteers, an Academy of Model Aeronautics (AMA) Charter Club (#1113) and a California not for Profit Corporation. This newsletter is sent monthly to all paid members, selected exchange and magazine editors. Non-Members may subscribe at \$15.00 per year within the U.S.A., offshore price will be adjusted to reflect the postage required. Materials from El Torbellino may be reproduced on an unlimited basis by other publications, but proper credit is requested.

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www.SanDiegoOrbiteers.com

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PHOTO CREDITS THIS ISSUE :

Arline Bartick p. 1, 4, 5
Clint Brooks p. 6, 7



2026 Jim Richmond Open, West Baden, IL (April 11-13, 2026)

F1D (AMA best two of 6 flights, no rounds)

Kang Lee	27:05	27:18	- 54:23
Brett Sanborn	28:54*	25:28	- 54:22
Emily Torkelson	24:26	26:23	- 50:49
John Kagen	26:15	24:01	- 50:16
(10 additional entries)			

* Open Record

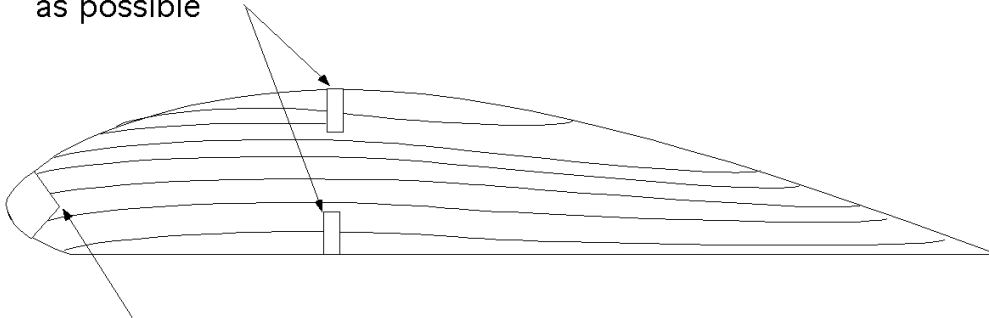
Wing Construction Improvements

By Mike Jester



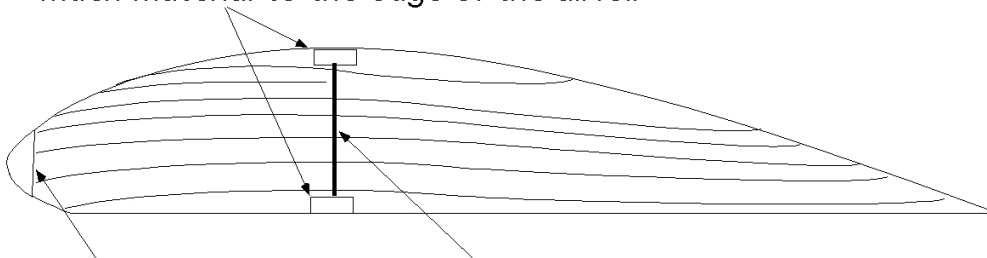
A couple of months ago I ran across the illustrations below on the latest reincarnation of the Hip Pocket Aeronautics website. They were posted by Konrad and suggest improvements to the standard built up balsa wood wing construction. The illustrations are self-explanatory.

Spars not as far apart
as possible



Wedge will split wood grain
far too easily
(This is also a problem with
round carbon LE)

Fix is to rotate spars to bring as
much material to the edge of the airfoil



Allow for flat plate LE to help
distribute impact loads against
more of the wood grain at 90°

The height of the ribs (depth of the flat bottom airfoil) is exaggerated in these illustrations and the trailing edge (LE) and typical third spar are missing. I usually only glue shear webs in the innermost bays of the wing when needed to impart extra stiffness to prevent the wing from folding in half. If the spars are 1/16-inch by 1/8-inch, the wing stiffness would likely be reduced in the outer bays when the spars are rotated to the position shown in the lower illustration.

April 19th SDO contest



P-30

1st Stan

2nd Clint

3rd Don

Mr. Thermal claimed two airplanes

Mike P & Henry Kruse

Power

1st Mike P

2nd Greg

CLG

1st David

2nd Stan

3rd Chris

Update:

Henry Kruse's P-30 was found by a construction worker and contacted his father.



MP

Photo's by Arline Bartick





On April 16, 2026 I flew a Sleek Streek model indoors at the Anaheim church gym we fly in every Thursday.



Okay, big deal, we all flew at least one of these in our lives at some point. I flew many-my weekly allowance as a fourth-grade kid was 25 cents, and a Sleek Streek was....25 cents. Plus a few pennies for the Guv, so maybe 28 or 29 cents total. Of course, this implies the period of the mid-sixties or thereabouts. And, this was a near weekly occurrence if candy desires didn't override the Sleek Streek purchase plan. It was a problem at times, the Sleek Streek source was the grocery market in the little town of Boulder Creek where my youth unfolded. Always on display was a box full of the North Pacific products; the little nickel priced hand launch gliders (good in a pinch if that's all you had for funds), the slightly larger hand launch glider that bumped cost to

a dime (again, decisions on the mix of candy and an airplane, or just the airplane). Then the more desirable products consisting of the Skeeter (another cut at 15 cents) then the prized Sleek Streek (and these were in short supply usually, because I was not alone in my hunt for this treasure). On top of this heap of goodness was the unattainable Star Flyer or whatever it was called, a large Sleek Streek-ish configuration with swept squared off wings and nowhere near as elegant as the elliptical wings and tail feathers of the Sleek Streek. Due to the fifty-cent cost, this airplane was seldom purchased as it required the discipline to retain two quarters and tax for two weeks. This was rarely achieved in my experience.

My brother and I were a constant presence flying models in front of our house which sat in a cul-de-sac in the middle of a forest of redwoods, Douglas fir, madrone and other native species. The subdivision had been cleared of some trees to make way for homes I suppose, so the immediate area was open enough to fly whatever it was we were attempting to fly at the time. Across the street from our house was another with a live oak tree in the front yard. If you are unfamiliar, this is the oak that has spiky leaf edges and fairly dense growth. It's unpleasant to walk on the leaves with bare feet, which was often as kids. And painfully hard to climb in when it was perceived as a requirement to retrieve things that ended up in it, such as Sleek Streek and Skeeter airplanes. This was the chief offending obstacle in the area, but there were other trees nearby that occasionally ensconced our beloved models, and that was that.

But what a great period for a few years as the Sleek Streek's gave way to more complex subjects such as offered by Guillows and Comet. And Cox products that led to other balsa control line and free flight models that utilized the salvaged Cox engines after the plastic RTF piece was damaged beyond use at some point. We tried it all; not much success with the Guillows and Comet articles, but if they didn't fly, they provided the basis of education on construction and covering, which paid off later in life. And when things seemed hopeless on that front, the simple satisfaction of seeing a Sleek Streek fly in the calm evening hours made it all okay. At least you could bear witness to the fact that it WAS possible to fly rubber powered model airplanes, and you probably shouldn't give up on whatever project was causing the grief. It was quite a mystery to me about how to transition from the robust flying Sleek Streek to something more tantalizing such as a rubber powered SE-5 or some such design that was being undertaken in hopes of equal flight performance in the making. Gradually, things progressed and successes were had, and the Sleek Streek faded into the history of my early youth aeronautical development.

Thursday's Sleek Streak had been obtained from my parent's house after my dad passed and my mom sold it to move into a more convenient home. As in, not in the middle of the forest somewhere far away from hospitals and other civilized things. My dad had tons of stuff in the basement where we built our models, Volkswagen engines and whatever other cool projects captivated us as we grew up. We were pitching in to clear the house of all the memories and junk so my mom could get it on the market. As I was mining through everything, I came across a new in the package Sleek Streak, hanging off a nail on a 2 x 4 stud in an open wall, tucked back in away from the main floor area. I think my dad had probably purchased this for his grandkids, as the price marked on the bag was thirty-nine cents, some inflationary times had impacted the value from the time we were coveting them. So most likely from the late 80's or so, maybe earlier. At this time, they were long gone from stores (this was 2021) and I was pleased to find it and took it into protective custody. Traveling to my home in Long Beach, it took up residence hanging near my workbench in plain view until I took it down and brought to the gym with me to share with the other guys, as there was an AJ Fireball or whatever it is named being sortied there by Larry Renger, and it usually prompted discussions about this type of model from our youth. The Sleek Streak was of course prominent in those reminiscences.

Flash forward to now. The plastic bag was still holding the model, but it had started to decay and had opened to the atmosphere in the dark basement area. The contents were exposed, and the red plastic items such as the wing clip, the prop and wheels had faded to pinkish white with time, and the prop had actually corroded with chunks missing off one tip. The wood components were fine; the wings had developed some under camber and had a fine brownish patina going on with the non-printed side, something I think may have been caused by the volatiles in the ink used to print the flashy Sleek Streak logo and scalloped red detailing on the upper surfaces. The paper tray everything sat in was stained brown in areas, again probably due to volatiles and probably humidity from the basement that leached water during heavy rains which were constant during the winter in Boulder Creek (that's why redwoods get so big there).



I happened to have a duplicate North Pacific prop from one of the MIT kits Larry has been promoting for the group at the gym, so I was going to be able to fly the Sleek Streak which I had brought this Thursday. So together it went. I fully expected the wing clip to split apart along the corners when installing the wing panels, but it didn't. Installing the wing clip onto the motor stick revealed it was just as tight and ill fitting as I remembered in my youth. But this is a blessing as it makes it easy to adjust incidence and CG as we all eventually learned. Tail bits went on just as intended-the die crushed outlines

where just as shabby as any of the Sleek Streak's I had bought so many years ago. It was comforting.

The rubber included in the package was now as strong as a dehydrated earthworm, and was amusing to watch crumble at the slightest pressure. I didn't expect it to be any good, and instead, I made up a small loop of 1/8 Super Sport rubber to substitute for whatever the rubber was back in the day. The model seemed small and insignificant-I remembered it as being much larger, but that was probably because I was much smaller.

First launch under low power was a serious plunge to the floor. Yeah, these were not the best for out of the bag success, but once you understood how to set them up, the duplicates usually were. So, I cranked in some wing incidence, moved the wing forward and was soon circling around at low power-things were looking good. Some bending influence on the fin to help with a left-hand circle under power, and I was getting up to the ceiling frames, and the magic of the Sleek Streak was back. And it was just as satisfying for me at 71 as it was when I was 11. Who would have thought? Thank you, North Pacific, for being a positive influence on so many of us.



**San Diego Orbiteers
Flying Schedule 2026
Taibi Field Perris, Ca**

<u>Primary Date</u>	<u>Rain Date</u>	<u>Event</u>
June 14	June 28	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
July 19	July 26	P-30/Glider/Power
August 16	Aug 23	Coupe/Glider/Power
September Hills, Ca	(TBD)	Free Flight Championships, Lost
September 20	September 27	OT/NOS Rubber/Glider/Power
October 18	October 25	P-30/Glider/Power
November	13,14&15	Dual Clubs, Lost Hill, Ca
November 22	November 29	Coupe/Glider/Power
December 13	No Date	Make-up
MP 12/25		

May 2026 Outdoor Contest

May 23 and 24

7 a.m. Set up

8 a.m. Pilots meeting

11:30 a.m. Last flight

CD: William Scott

wscott127@mac.com
(619) 701-2457

Studio 6 Suites
480 South Redlands
Perris, CA 92571
(951) 943-5577



Saturday 8 a.m. Pilot's meeting

Saturday's Mass Launches

WW 1: Sponsorship Available

8:30 a.m. WWI Mass Launch Photo

8:35 a.m. WWI Mass Launch

WW II: Sponsorship Available

9:30 a.m. WWII Mass Launch Photo

9:35 a.m. WWII Mass Launch

Sunday 8 a.m Pilot's meeting

Sunday's Mass Launches

Greve/Thompson Sponsorship Available

8:30 a.m. Greve/Thompson Mass Launch Photo

8:35 a.m. Greve/Thompson Mass Launch

Phantom Flash Sponsored by William Scott

9:30 a.m. Phantom Flash Mass Launch Photo

9:35 a.m. Phantom Flash Mass Launch

Fly Either Day*

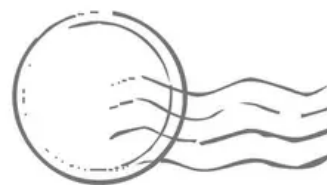
1. FAC Rubber Scale **Sponsored by Anonymous**
2. Embryo Endurance (ROG) **Sponsored by William Scott**
3. Golden Aged Combined
4. Old Time Rubber Stick and Fuselag (hand launched)
5. FAC 2Bit +1 and Jimmy Allen combined (ROG)
6. Phantom Flash (ROG)
7. Jet Catapult

*All flights must be made on the same day.

Web site

<https://sites.google.com/view/scalestaffel/home>

SAN DIEGO ORBITEERS
Howard L. Haupt / Editor
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San Diego, California 92117-4266



WHAT'S HAPPENING -

- May 20, 2026 - Oasis Flyers, 2ND Contest
Events: Blur Face, Fiction Flye, Sparky Duration
Contact Roger Willis for more info: willisasoc@aol.com
- May 23 / 24 - Scale Staffel Outdoor Contest
Taibi Flying Field, Perris CA, 7:00 start time.
See enclose contest flyer for schedule and events.
- June 14, 2026 - San Diego Orbiteer Outdoor Monthly
Taibi Flying Field, Perris CA, 7:30 start time.
Events: OT/NOS, Rubber/Glider/Power

